Arunachal Dam Watch

What exists, what is coming, how much land and forest it takes, and what has gone wrong. Compiled from government records, clearance papers and news reports up to 1 Nov 2026.

About **2,365** MW of large hydro runs today, plus **140.61** MW of small hydro, and **33** more projects are planned.

Large hydro (over 25 MW)

2,365

MW running now; Subansiri Lower counts only its 5 finished units of 8

Projects existing

4

large hydro (over 25 MW) operating or partly operating: Kameng, Panyor Lower, Pare and Subansiri Lower

Small hydro (under 25 MW)

140.61

MW installed, per Ministry of Power (Dec 2024). There's no official list or count of these plants, so how many exist is not known. Not included in the other figures.

Projects coming up

33

19,165 MW planned, per state govt; 19 have public records below

Forest land taken

7,761

hectares in Arunachal, projects built or under construction; Kameng, Panyor Lower and Pare publish no figure

Forest land sought

9,381

hectares, projects approved or in clearances

Trees cleared for felling

324K

permitted for projects built or underway; only Dibang has a published count

Trees to be felled

2.8M

in projects awaiting clearance or construction

People affected by incidents

106.8K

340 villages flooded; dam releases, failed flood control and site disasters only

Disasters linked to dams

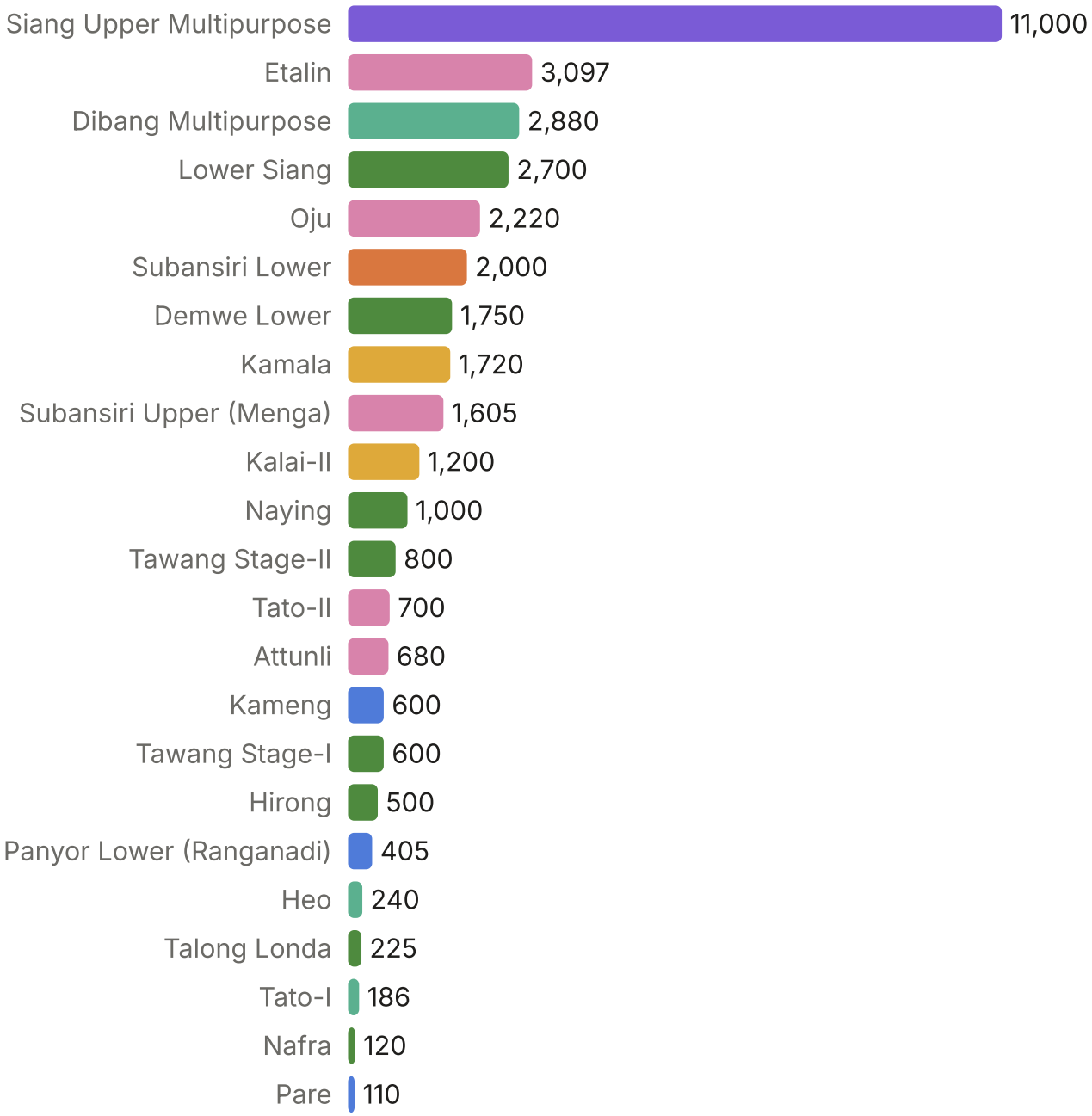
7

plus 10 site failures (warning signs)

Capacity by project

Megawatts, every project found, coloured by stage.

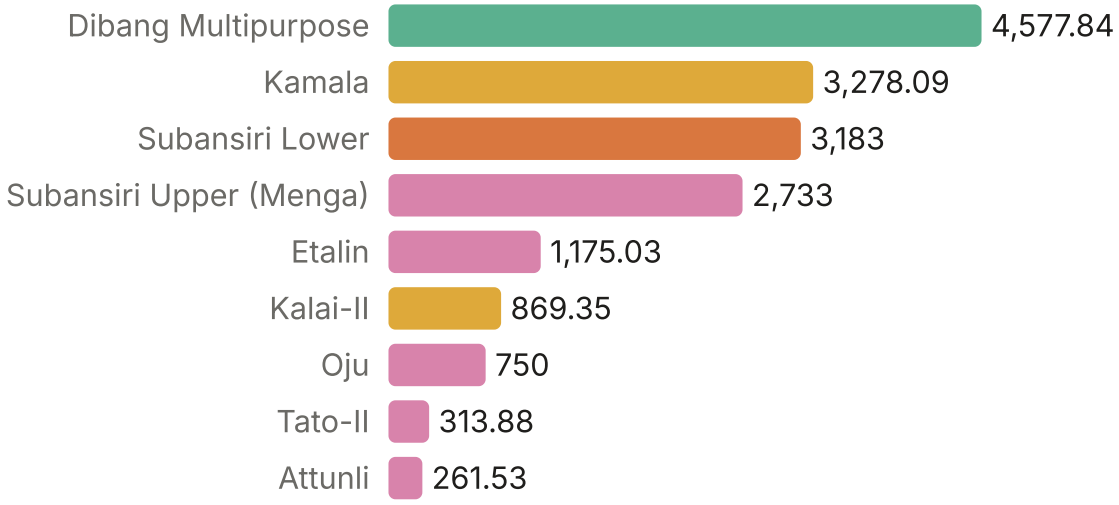
Operating · Partly operating · Under construction · Approved · Clearances in progress · Concurred, not started · Survey stage



Forest land by project

Hectares of forest diverted or sought, for every project in the capacity chart. Projects with no published figure are listed at the bottom as data not available.

Operating Partly operating Under construction Approved Clearances in progress Concurred, not started Survey stage



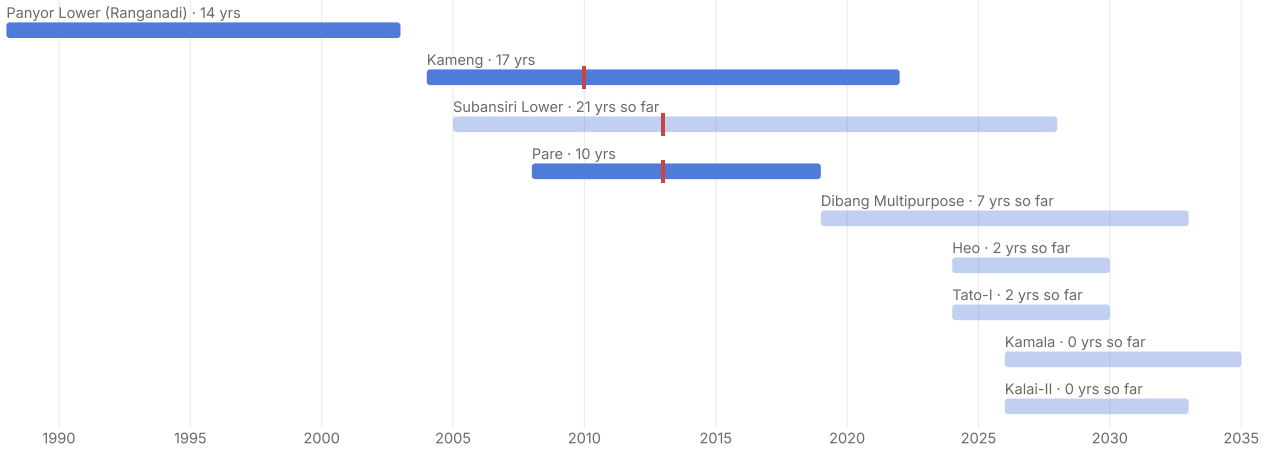
Data not available (14 projects)

- Siang Upper Multipurpose — Data not available
- Lower Siang — Data not available
- Demwe Lower — Data not available
- Naying — Data not available
- Tawang Stage-II — Data not available
- Kameng — Data not available
- Tawang Stage-I — Data not available
- Hirong — Data not available
- Panyor Lower (Ranganadi) — Data not available
- Heo — Data not available
- Talong Londa — Data not available
- Tato-I — Data not available
- Nafra — Data not available
- Pare — Data not available

How long each dam took, and what it cost

Bars run from approval or start of work to completion (solid) or target date (faded). The tick marks the originally planned finish. Costs in Rs crore.

Built Still to finish (target) Originally planned finish



Project	Stage	Start	Counted from	Planned finish	Finished / target	
Pare	Operating	2008	Approval	2012	2018	
Subansiri Lower	Partly operating	2005	Start of work	2012	2027	
Dibang Multipurpose	Under construction	2019	Approval	2032	2032	
Heo	Under construction	2024	Approval	2029	2029	
Tato-I	Under construction	2024	Approval	2029	2029	
Kamala	Approved	2026	Approval	2034	2034	jus
Kalai-II	Approved	2026	Approval	2032	2032	jus

Data not available means no reliable public figure was found. "Years taken" for unfinished projects counts years so far, to 2026. Panyor Lower and Subansiri Lower are counted from the start of work, the rest from approval, so their years are not strictly comparable. Costs are in the rupees of their own year, not adjusted for inflation.

All projects

Data not available marks figures not found in a reliable source. Tree counts are official figures from clearance papers: "cleared for felling" for projects built or under construction, "to be felled" for those still seeking approval. They are permitted or estimated counts, not trees confirmed cut. "Proposed" is the earliest documented step found (often CEA approval of the project report, so the idea may be older); "Started" is the start of work or government approval; dates and notes in amber are estimates or have gaps. Use the filters and sort controls below, or click a column heading to sort.

Stage: All stages | District: All districts | Developer: All developers

Sort by: Capacity (MW) | Descending ↓ | Reset

Showing **23** of 23 projects. Projects with no figure for the sorted column always go to the bottom.

Project	District	Stage	River	Developer	MW
Siang Upper Multipurpose	Siang, Upper Siang	Survey stage	Siang	NHPC	11,000
Etalin	Dibang Valley	Clearances in progress	Dri & Talo	SJVN	3,097
Dibang Multipurpose	Lower Dibang Valley, Dibang Valley	Under construction	Dibang	NHPC	2,880
Lower Siang	East Siang	Concurred,	Siang	Data not available	2,700

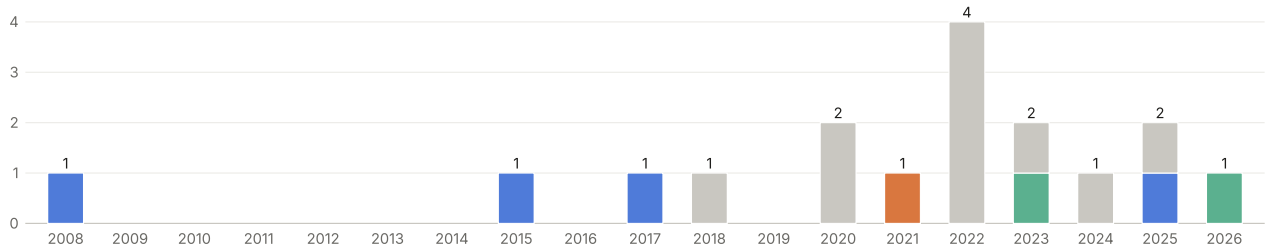
Disasters and site failures by year

Disasters are events that harmed people, land or the river beyond the project site. Site failures stayed within the site but show unstable ground or weak construction. Worker accidents are not included.

Flood from dam release Flood the dam failed to control Disaster at project site

Site failure (warning sign)

> For many incidents there is no official count of people affected, houses lost, livestock killed or crops damaged, and for some even deaths are uncertain. Project developers rarely publish incident reports, and district flood figures often don't separate a dam release from rain. The real scale of many incidents is likely larger than shown here, so treat these numbers as a minimum.



Disasters linked to dams

Floods caused or worsened by dam releases, floods a dam failed to hold back, and landslides or failures at projects that hit people or the river. Loss of life is noted in each description. Use the filters and sort controls, or click a column heading to sort. Not reported marks a figure no one published. Subansiri Lower sits on the Assam border, and Panyor Lower floods hit Lakhimpur in Assam.

Project

All projects

Type

All types

Sort by

Date

Descending ↓

Reset

Showing **7** of 7 disasters. Disasters with no figure for the sorted column always go to the bottom.

When	Project	Type	People affected	Villages flooded	Houses destroyed	In

When	Project	Type	People affected	Villages flooded	Houses destroyed	In
2015 (date not reported)	Panyor Lower (Ranganadi)	Flood from dam release	Not reported	Not reported		
14 Jun	Panyor	Flood	Not reported	Not reported		

Site failures: warning signs

Landslides, wall collapses and leaks at project sites that didn't harm anyone outside, but point to unstable ground or weak construction.

When	Project	Type	What happened	Source
11 Jun 2025	Subansiri Lower	Wall collapse	Guard wall beneath Spillway Gate Block 6 washed away; NDSA ordered extra grouting, delaying commissioning.	Assam Tribune
27 May 2024	Subansiri Lower	Landslide	Landslide on the right bank of the project after heavy rain; rocks fell from about 200 m up. One worker died.	India Today NE; SANDRP
3 Apr 2023	Subansiri Lower	Landslide	Part of a hill about 200 m upstream of the dam collapsed after heavy rain, affecting the diversion tunnels. NHPC said the main dam was not damaged.	EastMojo; Sentinel Assam; SANDRP
11 Oct 2022	Subansiri Lower	Landslide	A large section of hill on the left bank slid into the river, raising big waves and hitting the diversion tunnels; main dam work had already been halted.	Sentinel Assam; SANDRP
25 Sep 2022	Subansiri Lower	Wall collapse / flood	Temporary guard wall collapsed; floodwater entered the powerhouse; workers evacuated.	India Today NE; Arunachal Times; SANDRP
16 Sep 2022	Subansiri Lower	Sinkhole	Large sinkhole opened on the left bank, damaging diversion tunnel 2.	India Today NE; Sentinel Assam; SANDRP

What this does and doesn't cover

- The land total is a floor, not a full count. No official source adds up land under all existing dams; operating projects like Panyor Lower and Pare have no published land figures I could find.
- Project counts, charts and tables cover large hydro only (over 25 MW), the line the Central Electricity Authority uses. Small hydro is shown as one figure: the Ministry of Power's installed capacity as of 31 Dec 2024. No official list or count of the small plants was found, so the number of plants, their land use and any incidents at them are not covered. Dikshi (24 MW) and Khangtang (7 MW), which the state lists as commissioned, are among them.
- The state's own list of commissioned projects (5, Mar 2026) differs from the "Projects existing" count because it includes those two small plants and leaves out Subansiri Lower, which sits on the Assam border.
- Flood counts for 2017 and 2021 are district-wide, so they include damage from rain as well as from the dam. They are kept because a dam that releases or fails to hold back water can make a flood worse.
- "Forest land taken" counts only Arunachal's share; Subansiri Lower diverted another 816 ha in Assam.
- The state counts 33 projects coming up; the table lists only those with named public records.
- Worker accidents at construction sites are left out: this dashboard tracks harm to people, land and rivers beyond the projects.
- Every disaster and site-failure entry cites a news report. Many also cite SANDRP (South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People), an advocacy group that tracks dam accidents. Loss of life, where mentioned, is as reported by local media, not an official toll.
- Dam heights for Dibang (278 m, cut from 288 m) and Siang Upper (~300 m) are as reported; Siang Upper is still at survey stage.

Sources

Every report and record the figures on this page come from.

Government and official records

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- PIB – Ranganadi project commissioned, 2002
- News on Air – CCEA approves Heo and Tato-I, Nov 2024
- CEA – Status of under-execution hydro projects (Kameng)
- CEA – Schemes concurred, status of clearances
- MoEFCC – 47th EAC minutes, Kamala project, Jan 2026
- MoEFCC – Etalin forest diversion proposal

Projects, land and forest

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- Sentinel Assam – Fifth Subansiri Lower unit, full target moved to Mar 2027, Oct 2026
- NHPC – Subansiri Lower project details (dam height)
- NE Now – Subansiri Lower forest and reservoir figures
- NE Now – Subansiri Lower submergence area
- The Wire – Dibang land, submergence and trees
- Arunachal Times – Dibang dam height reduced

- NHPC – Dibang six-monthly environment report
- THDC – Kalai-II project details
- IIPA – Subansiri Upper social impact report
- Energetica India – CCEA approves Kamala and Kalai-II, Apr 2026
- Ministry of Power – Rajya Sabha reply: state-wise small hydro capacity, 31 Dec 2024
- CEA/CBIP (2022) – NE hydro status, CEA concurrence dates
- Business Standard – 12 projects re-allotted to PSUs, Aug 2023
- Construction World – Naying environmental clearance and targets, Jul 2026
- EastMojo – Nafra agreement with NEEPCO, Aug 2021
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- Business Standard – Dibang foundation stone, 2008
- SANDRP – Dibang foundation stone, 2008
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- Scroll – Siang Upper proposed by NITI Aayog, 2017
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- India Today NE – Subansiri Lower 13-year delay
- Arunachal Times – Subansiri Lower cost rises to Rs 26,000 crore
- Business Standard – Kamala and Kalai-II costs
- Water Power Magazine – Dibang completion target

Disasters, failures and impact

- Assam Times – Ranganadi floods 2008, 2017, 2025
- EastMojo – Kamala: 23 lakh trees
- NE Now – Kamala families affected and forest review, Oct 2026
- NE Now – Kalai-II and Attunli forest diversion
- TEI Times – Kalai-II forest clearance
- EastMojo – Etalin forest approval
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- Indian Express (via SuperKalam) – Subansiri Upper forest land, trees and dam height, Sept 2026
- ThePrint – Subansiri Upper clearance and trees, Sept 2026
- India Today NE – Oju clearance and families displaced, Sept 2025
- EastMojo – Siang Upper dam height
- Mongabay India – Siang Upper villages at risk
- Arunachal Times – Pare dam height
- Down To Earth – Lower Siang in East Siang district
- India Today NE – Demwe Lower in Lohit district
- India Today NE – Naying in Shi Yomi district
- Mountain Echo – Hirong among Shi Yomi projects
- GMR Group – Talong Londa in East Kameng
- Sentinel Assam – Nafra in West Kameng

- Assam Tribune – Ranganadi dam release floods villages
- NE Now – Ranganadi floods since 2008
- Scroll – Lakhimpur flood, Jul 2017
- Arunachal Times – Kameng penstock leaks, 2018
- NE Now – Subansiri coffer dyke breached, Jun 2020
- Sentinel Assam – Subansiri guard walls collapse, powerhouse flooded, Jul 2020
- Sentinel Assam – Floodwater rolls over Subansiri main dam, Aug 2021
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- Assam Tribune – Panyor flood houses and missing, Jun 2026

Data compiled from public records, clearance papers and news reports up to 1 Nov 2026. Figures are a minimum where reporting is incomplete; see sources above.